

Audio, Smell and Taste

As we mentioned earlier, for a complete VR experience all the senses have to be involved. On the audio front, a technology that has been around for a while is making a comeback thanks to VR. Binaural Audio, or more commonly, 3D Audio had taken a backseat compared to other methods that were technically less demanding when it came to content creation. This method involves placing high quality microphones on a dummy head's ears in such a way that it records each sound as heard from various directions. This sound, when played back on sufficiently high quality headphones, fools the brain into believing that it is experiencing the sound first hand.

FeelReal has developed a VR accessory that you can clip on to your headset and feel blasts of hot air, sprinkled water and even pre-loaded scents like jungle, metal, grass etc in conjunction with your VR experience. And for the taste-receptors in your tongue, Nimesha Ranasinghe's 'Digital Lolipop' uses tiny electrodes to pass non-harmful currents and temperature changes to simulate a sense of taste. Both these technologies are in a nascent stage and we will cover more on them in a later chapter.

Getting your hands dirty - Build your own VR headset!

If Palmer Luckey can do it in his backyard, so can you. We cannot stress enough that approaching VR technology has become so easy now, that practically anyone with a DIY spirit can do it with off-the-shelf material. Just follow these steps, or maybe tweak them a bit to your own liking, but do read all of them before you start. Who knows, we might get our own Oculus out of you!

Step 0: Yes, there is a step 0. And this is the step where you can eliminate the requirements of all other steps if it suits your need, thanks to Google Cardboard. This is the simplest, most basic way to experience VR if you have a smartphone. There are multiple cardboard kits available online, or you could head over to <http://dgit.in/GCboard> and download the layout of the components. Print them out on a piece of cardboard, or a paper to later trace on a cardboard. The page also has direct instructions from Google regarding how to assemble the same, although you would still need to procure magnifying lenses, magnets, Velcro and rubber bands. Once it's ready, download Google's Cardboard apps, snap in your Smartphone and you are all set!

Step 1: The Parts

Now, if you are still reading this, that means the basic cardboard design